DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA RETIREMENT BOARD (DCRB)
DRAFT* OPEN BOARD MEETING MINUTES
THURSDAY, January 29, 2026
1:30 P.M. via WebEx

***These draft minutes must be approved by the Board at its next Open Board meeting.**
Full meeting minutes will be posted after the next Open Board meeting.

MEMBERS PRESENT
Chair, Danny Gregg
Joseph M. Bress
Lyle M. Blanchard @1:37 p.m.
Joseph W. Clark
Christopher Finelli
Geoffrey Grambo
Tracy S. Harris
Chester McPherson
Greggory Pemberton
Nathan Saunders
Adam Weers
Carmen Pigler, Ex Officio

MEMBERS NOT PRESENT

DCRB STAFF PRESENT
JP Balestrieri, Executive Director
Kate Robinson
Violeta Curiel Gonzalez
Patrick Sahm
Paul Gormley
Ram Murthy
Daniel Hernandez
Vernon Valentine
Lauren Smith
Lori Morgan
Leslie West
David Mobley
Jaininne Edwards
Johniece Harris, Board Liaison

OTHERS PRESENT
Gar Chung-Financial News
Paul Biedlingmaier- General Public
Joe Ebisa-With Intelligence
Nichole Gilfield- General Public
Kande Hooten-Treasury

ROLL CALL
Chair Danny Gregg called the meeting to order at 1:32 p.m. and Ms. Johniece Harris called the roll.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES
Chair Gregg introduced a motion to approve the open session Board meeting minutes.

Motion#1: To approve the November 20, 2025, Open Board meeting minutes.

The motion was moved by Trustee Gregg and properly seconded by Trustee Weers.
The motion was approved by unanimous vote (9-0). *(See Tally #1)*

Tally #1			Date: January 29, 2026		
Motion #1: To approve the November 20, 2025, Open Board meeting minutes.					
Members	Aye	Nay/ Oppose	No Vote/ Abstain	No Vote/ Recuse	Absent
Gregg, Danny C., Chair	√				
Blanchard, Lyle M.	√				
Bress, Joseph M.	√				
Clark, Joseph W.	√				
Finelli, Christopher	√				
Grambo, Geoffrey P.	√				
Harris, Tracy S.	√				
McPherson, Chester			√		
Pemberton, Greggory J.	√				
Saunders, Nathan			√		
Weers, Adam	√				

Motion#2: To approve the December 16, 2025, Open Board meeting minutes.

The motion was moved by Trustee Gregg and properly seconded by Trustee Harris.
The motion was approved by unanimous vote (9-0). *(See Tally #2)*

Tally #2			Date: January 29, 2026		
Motion #2: To approve the December 16, 2025, Special Open Board meeting minutes.					
Members	Aye	Nay/ Oppose	No Vote/ Abstain	No Vote/ Recuse	Absent
Gregg, Danny C., Chair	√				
Blanchard, Lyle M.	√				
Bress, Joseph M.	√				
Clark, Joseph W.	√				
Finelli, Christopher	√				
Grambo, Geoffrey P.	√				
Harris, Tracy S.	√				
McPherson, Chester			√		
Pemberton, Greggory J.	√				
Saunders, Nathan			√		
Weers, Adam	√				

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CHAIR REPORT

Chair Gregg presented a report on the following topics:

- **In-Person Board Attendance:**
  Board meetings will continue virtually as well as in-person. Those Trustees who plan to meet in the Board room are welcome to do so, but please let staff know in advance.

- **New and Reappointed Board Members:**
  On January 7, 2026, Mayor Muriel Bowser reappointed **Mr. Joseph Clark** to a four-year term and **Ms. Tracy Harris** to 3-year term on the District of Columbia Retirement Board, beginning January 28, 2026.

  Mayor Bowser has appointed **Mr. Chester McPherson** as Trustee to serve a 2-year term beginning January 28, 2026.

  As announced at the December Special Meeting of the Board of Trustees, **Mr. Nathan Saunders** is the representative for retired DCPS teachers.

  Congratulations to our newly elected and appointed/reappointed board members. We appreciate your willingness to serve. Thank you for your dedication, leadership, and commitment to this organization. We look forward to the invaluable contributions you will make to our mission of serving all Plan participants.

- **Board & Committee Etiquette:**
  Preparation – review agenda, reports, and material in advance of meeting

  Professional Conduct – treat all members, staff, and guests with respect. Listen actively and avoid interrupting others. Disagree professionally – focus on issues, not individuals.

  Speaking Protocols – to avoid talking over another, address comments to the chair; stay on topic and keep remarks concise. Allow equal opportunity for all attendees to speak.

  Decision Making – support board decisions once a vote is taken, even if you disagree. Avoid revisiting settled matters unless current information becomes available.

  Computer Camera – if attending remotely, please turn on your camera and mute your audio until you intend to speak.

  Delegation of Authority – the Board of Trustees will focus on setting the overall direction, strategy, and policies for DCRB, and will delegate authority to the executive director (ED) and his management team to develop policies and procedures to handle day-to-day operations in accordance with Board decisions.

- **Governance:**
  The Board and the ED will create a vision for the organization while the professional staff will aid the Board by developing operational policies and procedures to effectively execute board decisions.

- **Investments:**
  This morning trustees received a thorough update from our CIO, Patrick Sahm, and the investment team on the Fund's performance. For this meeting, the executive director will provide a year-to-date overview of the Fund's performance, and the chair of the Investment Committee will update us about decisions made today by the Investment Committee for board consideration.

DRAFT

- **Standing Committees: Chairs and Vice Chairs of Standing Committees:**

➢ Investment Committee of the Whole–Chair Adam Weers/Vice Chair Tracy Harris
➢ Audit Committee – Chair Tracy Harris/Vice Chair Joseph Bress
➢ Benefits Committee – Chair Geoff Grambo/Vice Chair Greggory Pemberton
➢ Legislative Committee – Chair Lyle Blanchard/Vice Chair Joseph Clark
➢ Operations Committee - Chair Chris Finelli/Vice Chair Greggory Pemberton

- **Scheduled Meetings:**
  Trustees will meet every other month. A schedule is posted at DCRB website with dates and times.

  Committee meetings shall be held during the months a board meeting is not.

- **August – No Board or Committee Meetings:** Training sessions for all Trustees will be held prior to the Investment Committee meeting in the months the Board of Trustees meets. All Trustees are encouraged to seek out knowledge-based and skills-based training opportunities to better serve Plan participants.

- **Election of Executive Board Officers:**
  The election for executive board officers will occur at the Board meeting on March 19, 2026.
  The positions for consideration are:

  ➢ Chair of the Board
  ➢ Vice Chair/Secretary of the Board
  ➢ Treasurer/Audit Committee Chair

- **BEGA Ethics Training:**
  The Board of Ethics and Government Accountability (BEGA) is conducting Ethics Training for board members on Wednesday, April 29, 2026.

  An email will be sent to your dc.gov email addresses with a link to register to attend the training.

- **Annual Open Public Meeting Schedule:**
  A schedule of the Annual Open Public Meetings of DCRB Board of Trustees for calendar year 2026 is posted to DCRB's website.

  Trustees will find the schedule posted to Diligent as well.

- **Active Teacher Special Election:**
  A special trustee election for the Active Teacher representative is underway. Ballots were mailed on January 7, 2026; the election will close on February 6, 2026. The ballots will be certified by the Board of Trustees at a Special Board meeting on February 17, 2026.

- **Reminders:**

  March Board Meeting - **March 19, 2026**.

  Boardroom Telephone Numbers:

  ➢ JP Balestrieri, Executive Director, 202.343.3228
  ➢ Johniece Harris, Board Liaison, 202.343.3228

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Electronic Participation: Webex information is sent to all Trustees prior to scheduled Board and Committee meetings. Should you encounter a problem, please contact Johniece by email at Johniece.Harris@dc.gov.

Complaints from Plan Participants: please refer complaints from Plan participants to the department head responsible for addressing the issue with a courtesy notification to the executive director.

DCRB Laptops: use of a DCRB laptop is to access your official DC.Gov email account and the Board portal at Diligent. The laptop is used solely for official government business. To safeguard the laptop against unwanted intrusions and to ensure it has the most recent version of installed software, users should log on at least weekly to upload

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda

EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR'S REPORT

Executive Director, JP Balestrieri, presented a report on the following topics:

1. **Staffing Update**

   a. **New and Pending Hires**
   b. **Current Vacancies to Fill**

2. **Fiscal Year 2026 Fund Performance and Investment Update (As of 1/27/2026)**

   a. **Total Market Value of the Fund:** a new high of $14.1 billion
   b. **Firm Fund Liquidity:** Currently, the Fund holds approximately $132 million in cash.
   c. **Net Returns to the Fund:**
      i. Calendar Year End 2025: 14.1%
      ii. Fiscal Year Ended 2025: 10.25%
      iii. Fiscal YTD 2026: 4.3%
      iv. Last twenty (20) Years Average: the net return has averaged +6.6% per annum

3. **Asset Allocation & Rebalancing Update (As of 1/27/2026)**

The DCRB investment team monitors the portfolio's asset allocation daily to ensure the asset allocation stays in line with targets and that there is sufficient liquidity to meet benefit payments, capital calls, and other operational needs.

   a. **Since the last board meeting:** the investment team has completed another 10 rebalancing transactions valued at about $238 million.
   b. **FY End 2025**: the investment team has completed 103 rebalancing transactions valued at approximately $5.421 billion.
   c. **FY 2026 to date**: the investment team has completed 20 rebalancing transactions valued at approximately $400 million.

4. **Closings Since last Board Meeting:**

1. Closed on a $100mn **re-up** commitment on 11/26/2025 in Quantum Energy Partners IX.

2. Closed on a $100mn **re-up** commitment on 12/5/2025 in Updata Fund VIII.

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5. DCRB Annual Audited Financial Statements for Fiscal Year End 2025

DCRB's financial statements are audited annually, and we continue to attain and maintain unqualified audit opinions and report our financial activities according to required governmental accounting standards. On December 12th, 2025, DCRB's auditors, BCA Watson Rice LLP (BCAWR), issued its opinion and identified no material weaknesses in internal control over financial reporting for DCRB.

6. DCRB Awards:

a) **GFOA Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting**

On December 8th, 2025, DCRB was awarded with the Government Finance Officers Association's (GFOA) Certificate of Achievement for Excellence in Financial Reporting. This marks the seventeenth consecutive year that DCRB has received this award, which was granted for the FY 2024 Annual Comprehensive Financial Report (ACFR).

b) **Pension Coordinating Council's (PPCC) Public Pension Standards Award**

DCRB was also among a select number of public retirement systems that received the Public Pension Coordinating Council's (PPCC) Public Pension Standards Award for 2025 in recognition of meeting professional standards for plan design funding and administration.

7. Stakeholder Outreach: Trainings and Workshops

The Benefits team continues to lead a very proactive stakeholder outreach program continues in fiscal year 2025 focused on training and workshops with employer agencies.

a. December 2nd, 2025 – Winter Retreat with Stakeholder Agencies
b. December 10th, 2025 – DC Fire and EMS Pre-Retirement Seminar

8. Benefits Administration Pension System (BAPS) RFP Process

The BAPS procurement Technical Evaluation Panel (TEP) selected 3 finalist RFP bid candidates and provided an updated review before the operations committee in October 2025. Management followed up with the TEP on full day demos with each finalist candidate during the week of November 10th, 2025. The TEP panel concluded its evaluation process and presented its recommendation to the Operations Committee in December 2025. The Operations Committee reviewed and approved recommending the RFP contract award to the Board for approval.

Trustee Saunders commented that he wanted to publicly recognize that Executive Director and Chief Investment Officer have been moving aggressively in the right direction with getting local schools and universities involved with internships.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda

LEGAL DEPARTMENT REPORT

No material developments to report. DCRB's attorneys continue making progress on long-term projects and goals for FY26. Please review the update provided in "Trustees Only Diligent" regarding the Clark litigation.

Kate Robinson, Interim General Counsel, confirmed that the DC Office of Attorney General filed a reply in *Clark vs. District of Columbia, et.* al, on January 27, 2026, and that the complaint is now fully briefed and pending decision by the DC Superior Court.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda

DRAFT

INVESTMENT COMMITTEE REPORT

Committee Chair Weers reported that the Investment Committee met earlier today. The official actions taken at this meeting are presented below for ratification by the Board of Trustees.

Motion #3: To approve a commitment of up to $150 million to "Fund AN"*, a private infrastructure fund, pending legal review and final due diligence. The commitment is in line with DCRB's investment policy statement and asset allocation.

The motion was moved by Chair Weers and properly seconded by Trustee Finelli.
The motion was approved unanimous vote (10-0). *(See Tally #3)*

Tally #3			Date: January 29, 2026		
Motion #3 To approve a commitment of up to $150 million to "Fund AN"*, a private infrastructure fund, pending legal review and final due diligence. The commitment is in line with DCRB's investment policy statement and asset allocation.					
Members	Aye	Nay/ Oppose	No Vote/ Abstain	No Vote/ Recuse	Absent
Gregg, Danny C., Chair	√				
Blanchard, Lyle M.	√				
Bress, Joseph M.	√				
Clark, Joseph W.	√				
Finelli, Christopher	√				
Grambo, Geoffrey P.	√				
Harris, Tracy S.	√				
McPherson, Chester	√				
Pemberton, Greggory J.					√
Saunders, Nathan	√				
Weers, Adam	√				

In addition, DCRB completed the following new investments since the last Investment Committee meeting:

1. A $100 million commitment to Quantum Energy Partners IX, a private natural resources fund, on November 26, 2025.

2. A $100 million commitment to Updata Fund VIII, a private equity fund, on December 5, 2025.

Trustee Clark asked if the Board has to do the Conflict-of-Interest Disclosure in the public session? Chair Weers replied no, it is not required to be done again.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda.

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OPERATIONS COMMITTEE REPORT

Committee Chair Finelli reported The Operations Committee meeting was held on December 16th, 2025, with an agenda that included three items:

- The approval of minutes from its October 21st, 2025, meeting;
- A "*Valuation Analysis*" presentation from Bolton, DCRB's actuary; and
- A presentation on DCRB's vendor-selection for the BAPS project.

Following discussion during and after Bolton's presentation, the Committee approved moving forward with the following motion for full Board review and vote:

To accept and approve the Report on the Actuarial Valuations of the District of Columbia Teachers' Retirement Plan and the District of Columbia Police Officers and Firefighters' Retirement Plan, prepared as of October 1, 2025, for Fiscal Year ending 2027, presented to the Operations Committee by Bolton, Inc. on December 16, 2025.

PRESENTED TO THE OPERATIONS COMMITTEE ON DECEMBER 16, 2025.

In the special Board meeting that immediately followed the Committee meeting, the Board voted to approve the motion.

Likewise, following discussion during and after the BAPS project update, the Committee approved moving forward with the motion for full Board review and vote. It is presented now for ratification by the full Board.

To recommend the Board authorize the Executive Director to negotiate and execute a 10-year contract with the qualified Contractor (Proposal C),

• to provide professional services to implement the Benefits Administration Pension System (BAPS), and ongoing support, for a base period of two years at $8,730,249 and additional 20% project contingency for a total of $10,480,000; and
• Years 3 through 10 of the contract term not to exceed $9,100,000 in total.

The total contract amount shall not exceed $19,580,000 subject to contract negotiations.

PRESENTED TO THE BOARD ON JANUARY 29, 2026.

The next Operations Committee is scheduled to be held on Tuesday, February 17th, at 1pm.
This concludes my report.

Motion #4: To recommend the Board authorize the Executive Director to negotiate and execute a 10-year contract with the qualified Contractor (Proposal C),

• to provide professional services to implement the Benefits Administration Pension System (BAPS), and ongoing support, for a base period of two years at $8,730,249 and additional 20% project contingency for a total of $10,480,000; and

• Years 3 through 10 of the contract term not to exceed $9,100,000 in total.

The total contract amount shall not exceed $19,580,000 subject to contract negotiations.

The motion was moved by Trustee Finelli and properly seconded by Trustee Grambo.
The motion was approved unanimous vote (11-0). *(See Tally #4)*

Tally #4				Date: January 29, 2026	
Motion #4: To recommend the Board authorize the Executive Director to negotiate and execute a 10-year contract with the qualified Contractor (Proposal C), • to provide professional services to implement the Benefits Administration Pension System (BAPS), and ongoing support, for a base period of two years at $8,730,249 and additional 20% project contingency for a total of $10,480,000; and • Years 3 through 10 of the contract term not to exceed $9,100,000 in total. The total contract amount shall not exceed $19,580,000 subject to contract negotiations.					
Members	Aye	Nay/ Oppose	No Vote/ Abstain	No Vote/ Recuse	Absent
Gregg, Danny C., Chair	√				
Blanchard, Lyle M.	√				
Bress, Joseph M	√				
Clark, Joseph W.	√				
Finelli, Christopher	√				
Grambo, Geoffrey P.	√				
Harris, Tracy S.	√				
McPherson, Chester	√				
Pemberton, Greggory J.	√				
Saunders, Nathan	√				
Weers, Adam	√				

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda.

AUDIT COMMITTEE REPORT

Committee Chair Harris reported The Audit Committee met on December 16, 2025, and the following items were presented:

- FY 25 Audit Presentation:
  - Watson Rice provided their final communication to the committee:
    - The FY 25 financial statements were issued on December 12th with an unmodified (clean) opinion.
    - The FY 25 Compliance Report under Government Audit Standards was also issued with an unmodified (clean) opinion. Watson Rice did not identify any internal control matters or findings during their audit.
    - A motion for the approval of the financial statements was approved by the Audit Committee.

- The Budget vs Actual report as of November 30, 2025:
  - At the end of November, $28.8M, representing 72% of the original FY 2026 budget, remained available for expenditure.

- Internal Auditor Report:
  - The Internal Audit Director presented an update on both completed and ongoing audits, highlighted findings and offered recommendations for process improvements. Further details

were provided on the following audits:

- Cybersecurity Internal Controls Documentation: The significance of documenting cyber-
- security controls in alignment with NIST framework was emphasized. Additionally, it was recommended that comprehensive desktop procedural documents be created to outline the process for maintaining cybersecurity internal controls documentation and effectively responding to incidents.
- Operational Due Diligence (ODD) – The responsibility for the ODD process has recently shifted from Meketa to the Investment Team. Following an evaluation of the team's execution of the ODD process for a recent investment proposal, it was recommended to thoroughly document the procedure, encompassing post-closing investment monitoring.

The next Audit Committee meeting is scheduled for February 17, 2026.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda.

BENEFITS COMMITTEE REPORT

Committee Chair Grambo The Benefits Committee did not meet in December, but the next meeting is scheduled for Thursday, February 19, 2026, at 10 a.m. EST. Below is a summary of recent Benefits Department activities.

Healthcare Open Enrollment Processing – Healthcare Open Enrollment ended in December, and we have completed processing Federal and District health plan changes. Members who changed health plans receive new cards in late January/early February.

District Life Insurance Special Open Enrollment Processing – The Special Open Enrollment for District life insurance enrollment ended in December, and we are working with the STAR IT staff to implement the new rates and provisions. Members will see the new deductions beginning with their March 1, 2026, annuity payments.

Equalization – The new MPD Union and Non-Union pay schedules have impacted retirees who retired prior to February 18, 1980. Members are scheduled to see their adjustments in their March 1, 2026, annuity payments. Letters to members announcing their annuity change will be sent to members prior to the March 1 pay date.

Cost of Living Adjustments – On January 13, 2026, the Bureau of Labor Statistics released the newest Consumer Price Index Reports. DCRB is working with DCHR and Treasury to review final COLA percentages which will be applied to annuitants' April 1, 2026, payments.

1099-Rs Online – The annual 1099-R tax forms will be mailed to members at the end of January. Members can also log into their annuitant self-service portal to retrieve a digital copy of the form, which will be available in early February. DCRB will communicate the availability of online tax forms via our website and mailed earning statements.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda.

LEGISLATIVE COMMITTEE REPORT

Committee Chair Blanchard reported on the following report reflects activities of interest since the November 20, 2025, Board Meeting:

Council of the District of Columbia

Legislation:

- **Fiscal Year 2026 Budget Support Congressional Review Emergency Amendment Act of 2025 (DC Act 26-210).** In Subtitle D of Title III of Act 26-210, the Council has amended the Retired Police Officer Redeployment Amendment Act of 1992, on an emergency basis, to allow rehiring of retired MPD officers and Fire and Emergency Services Department (FEMS) firefighters for certain roles without requiring any offset to their retirement benefits.

- **District of Columbia Boards and Commissions Financial Reporting Temporary Amendment Act of 2025 (B26-0519).** On December 19, 2025, the Council adopted a temporary amendment to section 5710 of Title 3 of the District of Columbia Municipal Regulations to further clarify the applicability date for the expanded financial reporting requirements enacted by the Board of Ethics and Government Accountability ("BEGA") for certain boards and commissions. The period for Mayoral review ended on January 12, 2026, and the legislation is currently subject to the 30-day Congressional review period. This law postpones the effective date of BEGA's new requirements to April 3, 2026.

- **First Responder Retention Efforts Emergency Declaration Resolution of 2026 (Resolution 26-305).** On January 6, 2026, the Council adopted an emergency resolution to amend the Policemen and Firemen's Retirement and Disability Act to remove the mandatory retirement age for MPD and FEMS employees. The elimination of the mandatory retirement age allows MPD and FEMS employees to continue working past age 60. However, both the Emergency (Bill 26-353) and Temporary (Bill 26-354) were amended to cover only members of the U.S. Secret Service and Park Police. The Committee on the Judiciary and Public Safety is still considering changes to the Senior Officer Program through permanent legislation (B26-358) pending before the Committee. A hearing was held on December 4, 2025, and markup is currently scheduled for February 23, 2026.

Other

- **District of Columbia Retirement Board - Notice of Public Interest - Certification of Winner of the Election to Serve as the Retired Teacher Member of the Board.** The District of Columbia Retirement Board (the "Board"), through election manager YesElections, conducted an election for a District of Columbia Retired Teacher to serve on the Board as an elected representative. YesElections submitted the Certificate of Results to the Board on December 17, 2025, declaring Mr. Nathan A. Saunders, a retired District of Columbia Public Schools teacher, as the winner. Pursuant to the Election Rules at 7 DCMR section 1522, The Board certified the results of the election and published notice of the outcome in the DC Register.

- **Notice to Appoint Interim Chief, Metropolitan Police Department.** Mr. Jeffery Carroll has been appointed as Interim Chief of MPD and shall serve in that capacity at the pleasure of the Mayor.

- **Notice on Public Hearing for the Committee on the Judiciary & Public Safety – District of Columbia Retirement Board.** The Council will hold public hearings on agency performance for FY 2025 and FY 2026 before the Committee of the Whole. The performance hearing for DCRB is scheduled for Wednesday, February 11, 2026. This hearing can be viewed live on the Council's website.

- **The Council of the District of Columbia Appointment.** Dani Crawford, a former staffer of Councilmember Kanyan McDuffie, was appointed as an interim At-Large Councilmember for the Council. She fills the vacancy left by Kanyan McDuffie. Ms. Crawford was sworn in on January 20, 2026, and will serve until July 1, 2026. A special election will be held on June 16, 2026, for her replacement.

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Trustee Blanchard stated that he has requested a meeting with Chair Mendelson regarding the BEGA reporting requirements for trustees. Vice-Chair Bress reminded the trustees that there will be a Special Board meeting December 16, 2025.

Trustees moved to the next item on the agenda.

There being no further business to come before the Board of Trustees, Chair Gregg introduced a motion to adjourn the meeting.

Motion #5: To adjourn the meeting at 2:26 pm.

The motion was moved by Chair Gregg and properly seconded by Trustee Harris.
The motion was approved by unanimous vote (11-0). (See Tally #5)

Tally #5				Date: January 29, 2026	
Motion #5 To adjourn the meeting at 2:26 pm.					
Members	Aye	Nay/ Oppose	No Vote/ Abstain	No Vote/ Recuse	Absent
Gregg, Danny C., Chair	√				
Blanchard, Lyle M.	√				
Bress, Joseph M.	√				
Clark, Joseph W.	√				
Finelli, Christopher	√				
Grambo, Geoffrey P.	√				
Harris, Tracy S.	√				
McPherson, Chester	√				
Pemberton, Greggory J.	√				
Saunders, Nathan	√				
Weers, Adam	√				

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